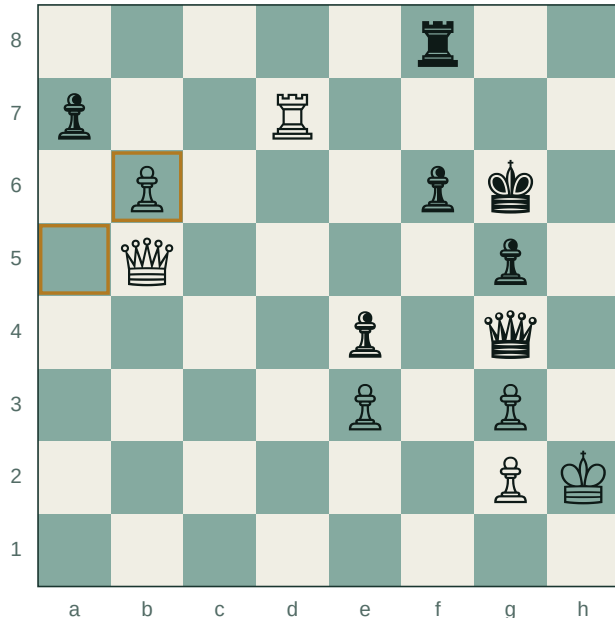


Deflection tactics: Black, move 34

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 34.axb6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34...Rh8+ 35. Kg1 Qxg3

34...Rh8+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **35.Kg1**.

35...Qxg3 The queen captures the pawn on g3.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: queen on b5. Check for tactical protection.